IDEA PITCH GUIDE

IDEA PITCH Presentation + Poster

Purpose of the IDEA PITCH:

The objectives of this presentation are to:

- Pitch your PI–CDIO idea
- Address a clearly defined problem or need
- Apply professional pitching techniques
- Present a compelling commercial-style poster
  - **This is NOT a technical presentation. It is a persuasive pitch.**

Presentation Overview

- ***Presentation Duration :*** 15 minutes
- ***Q&A Session :*** 5 minutes
- ***Format:*** Structured pitch + POSTER

Evaluation criteria

Area	*Expectation*
Structure (PPT Content & Design)	Strict adherence to prescribed outline Strong logical flow Effective transitions Visually appealing design
Pitch Structure & Persuasiveness	Clear professional pitch structure Effective integration of multiple pitching techniques Strong persuasive audience engagement
Poster Design & Communication Effectiveness	Highly professional and well-organized design Visually balanced and easy to read Clear and persuasive communication of key elements
Time Management	Disciplined time management (strict adherence to the 15-minute limit) Punctuality (on-time arrival)
Delivery & Presentation Skills	Confident and professional delivery Clear and strong voice projection Effective audience engagement Strong presenter presence

I. IDEA PITCH Outline

- The goal of this presentation is **not to explain technical details**, but to **create impact**.
- Your pitch should follow the **IMPACT model**, which helps transform a technical idea into a persuasive message.

IMPACT means:

- **I – Ignite curiosity**
- **M – Make the problem real**
- **P – Present the shift**
- **A – Amplify the value**
- **C – Chart the future**
- **T – Trigger action**
  - ➢ **The goal is to capture attention, make the audience feel the problem, show the value of your solution, and leave them with a strong message.**

1. Introduction (IGNITE -Capture Attention)

- Start by grabbing the audience's attention immediately.
- Your opening should create curiosity or surprise.
- Avoid starting with definitions or technical explanations.

Possible pitching techniques:

✓ **Provocative question**
- Ask a question that makes the audience think.

✓ **Unexpected statistic**
- Use a surprising fact to highlight the importance of the topic.

✓ **Short scenario**
- Present a relatable real-life situation.

✓ **Bold claim**
- Start with a strong statement that challenges expectations.
  - ➢ **Make the audience curious and attentive within the first seconds.**

2. THE PROBLEM (MAKE THE PROBLEM REAL)

Clearly explain the problem your idea addresses.
Focus on:

- Who experiences the problem
- Why it matters
- What consequences it creates

Possible pitching techniques:

- ✓ **Emotional framing:**
- Show human, economic, or societal impact of the problem.
- Make consequences tangible.

- ✓ **Consequence amplification**
- Highlight what is lost (time, money, safety, efficiency).

- ✓ **FOMO:**
- ➢ Stress what continues to be lost without intervention.
- ➢ Show growing urgency.
  - ➢ **Make the audience feel the urgency of the problem.**

3. THE SOLUTION (PRESENT THE SHIFT & AMPLIFY THE VALUE)

Introduce your solution as the turning point.
Show your POSTER (the POSTER must follow the requirements in section **II**).
Explain:

- What your solution is
- What it allows people to do differently i.e. what improves for the user.
- Focus on outcomes (e.g., saves time, reduces cost, improves safety, increases efficiency etc.), **NOT FEATURES**
  - ➢ **Avoid deep technical details**

Possible pitching techniques:

- ✓ ***The Hero narrative:***
  - The situation (Before): Describe the user operating under limitation, uncertainty, or inefficiency. Keep it short and concrete.
  - The intervention (Turning Point): Introduce your solution as the decisive change that shifts the situation.
  - Show how the user now operates differently with more control, efficiency, confidence, or capability.

  - ➢ **Present your solution as innovation, not incremental improvement i.e. do not present your idea as a small upgrade to something that already exists.**

4. FUTURE OUTLOOK (CHART THE FUTURE)

Move beyond the current solution and **project the long-term potential of the idea**.
Demonstrate that the idea is **not only a future product or service**, but **a step toward a broader and lasting transformation**.
Briefly explore the **long-term impact of their idea after years of use, development, and implementation**.

Address questions such as:

- How could this idea evolve or improve over time?
- What long-term benefits could emerge after continuous use and development?
- How might it influence the industry, society, or user behavior in the long run?
- What new opportunities or innovations could grow from this idea in the future?

➢ **Rather than describing technical upgrades, you should focus on impact, scalability, and long-term possibilities etc.**

Possible Pitching Techniques

✓ **FOMO (Fear of Missing Out)**

- Create a sense that **early adoption leads to long-term advantage**, while ignoring the innovation may result in **missed opportunities** (i.e. multiple layers of long-term and positive impact across users, industries, or society etc.) **or reduced competitiveness** etc.

5. CONCLUSION (TRIGGER ACTION)

End your presentation with a strong and memorable conclusion.
Your closing should:

- Summarize the value of the idea
- Project a positive future
- Call To Action: Invite the audience to support the idea

Possible pitching techniques:

✓ **FOMO**

- Highlight the opportunity that could be missed if the idea is not adopted, emphasizing the benefits of acting early.

✓ **Call To Action:**

- You may use different forms of CTA, such as:
  -**Invitation** – encouraging the audience to explore or support the idea
  Example: "Join us in creating a smarter way to …."
  -**Challenge** – asking the audience to rethink current practices
  Example: "It is time to rethink how…."
  -**Vision Statement** – inviting the audience to be part of a better future
  Example: "Together, we can move toward …."

II. Poster Requirements

1. HEADLINE (Big Promise)

- Clearly state the **VALUE**
- Focus on outcome, not technology

Formula: Achieve [desired result] without [pain/problem]

STRONG HEADLINE	WEAK HEADLINE
Detect Equipment Failure Before It Happens	"Smart IoT Monitoring System Using AI"

2. THE PROBLEM (1–2 lines only)

- Make the audience feel the pain
- Be specific i.e. mention WHO is affected and show WHY it matters
- Show urgency i.e. include impact (cost, time, risk, stress etc.)

Formula: [Target User] frequently faces [problem], causing [quantified loss or serious consequence].

STRONG PROBLEM	WEAK PROBLEM
"Small factories frequently face unexpected machine breakdowns, causing up to 30% productivity loss each year."	"Machine downtime affects operational performance."

3. THE SOLUTION (Visual + Short Explanation)

- ***Visual representation (Mandatory):*** The solution must be presented visually. The format is not restricted and may take any appropriate form that clearly communicates how the solution works:
  - System diagram
  - Process flow (maximum 3–5 steps)
  - Application interface screenshot
  - Prototype or machine image etc.
- **The visual must be simple and easy to understand within 10–15 seconds.**

- ***Core explanation (Maximum 1–2 sentences):*** Add a short explanation describing:
  - What your solution is
  - How it works at a high level
  - How it addresses the problem

- **Do NOT include** technical specifications**,** equations**,** or long paragraphs.
- **A non-technical audience should understand; what the system does, how it works (basic idea), and what outcome it produces.**

4. THREE KEY BENEFITS (Not Features)

- The poster must include **exactly three (3) key benefits** of the proposed solution.
- Benefits must describe the **value or positive outcome** delivered to the user, not technical features.
- Each benefit must:

- Be written in one single line
- Be concise and impact-focused
- Be expressed in clear, non-technical language
- Include quantification where possible (%, time saved, cost reduced, etc.)

5. UNIQUENESS (Competitive advantage)

- Demonstrate what differentiates your solution from existing alternatives.
- Include one (1) clear statement explaining why your solution is unique.
- The statement must answer the question:
- ***Why should a customer choose your solution instead of others?***

6. EVIDENCE (Proof of credibility)

- Claims presented without supporting evidence will be considered commercially weak.
- The poster must include at least one (1) form of proof to validate the effectiveness of the solution.
- Acceptable forms of evidence may include:
  - Quantitative results (percentages, cost savings, time reduction).
  - Testing or pilot results
  - Performance comparisons
  - User feedback or testimonial excerpts
  - Experimental validation data etc.

7. Call to Action (CTA) + QR Code + CONTACT INFO

- The **CTA** must:
  - Clearly state the action the audience should take
  - Use direct, action-oriented language
  - Indicate what the audience will gain
  - Be visible and easy to identify on the poster
- **The CTA should create a sense of purpose and immediacy.**

- The **QR** code must:
  - Be clearly visible
  - Be large enough to scan easily
  - Direct to a working link